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# Senior Software Engineer (£44,241 to £58,997)

Driver and Vehicle Licensing Agency

**Apply before 11:55 pm on Sunday 11th October 2026**



## Reference number

481111

## Salary

£44,241 - £58,997

Digital and Data allowance of up to £14,756

A Civil Service Pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

## Job grade

Senior Executive Officer

**Contract type**

Permanent

**Business area**

DVLA - Information Technology Services

**Type of role**

Digital  
Information Technology

**Working pattern**

Flexible working, Full-time, Job share, Part-time

**Number of jobs available**

2

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## Location

Swansea

# About the job

## Job summary

Can you see yourself working with the latest technologies reaching 53 million users? If so, we are expanding our team and would love to hear from you!

Joining our department comes with many benefits, including:

Employer pension contribution of 28.97% of your salary. Read more about Civil Service Pensions [Contribution rates](#)

25 days annual leave, increasing by 1 day each year of service (up to a maximum of 30 days annual leave), plus 8 bank holidays and a privilege day for the King's birthday

Flexible working options where we encourage a great work-life balance.

Read more in the Benefits section below!

Find out more about what it's like working at [Driver and Vehicle Licensing Agency - Department for Transport Careers](#).

## Job description

The Driver and Vehicle Licensing Agency (DVLA) deliver wide reaching digital services to the UK public and industry. We maintain the national record of vehicles and drivers. If you have applied for a driving licence, changed vehicle, re-licensed your vehicle or completed a vehicle enquiry you would have used one of our services.

The time is right to join one of the leading agile, cloud and technical departments in the government, one that is constantly pushing the boundaries of technological innovation to find, develop, and introduce new and innovative technological advancements. On a modern cloud platform, we work with a range of industry-leading technologies, such as serverless, Docker, and Kubernetes.

If you are successful, you will be part of the new electronic Vehicle Excise Duty programme which is a new legislative, digital service being delivered by

DVLA to modernise how Vehicle Excise Duty is administered and delivered digitally. This is an exciting time to join us!

Within and between our teams, we have a friendly and stable engineering community. Keeping work life enjoyable is key to us, and we strive to ensure the efficient and secure use of software and infrastructure.

Our current deliveries include:

- Two major programmes of work, modernising our drivers and vehicles services and systems.

- Entirely new services including a new customer portal, mobile digital driving licence and identity platform.

- The DVLA digital payment service that helps us collect around 6 billion pounds a year.

- New versions of key driving licence services that will help us to reduce paper forms, reduce waiting times and to enable all of our customers to transact digitally.

As part of our core business services, you will work with Java and SpringBoot alongside tools like OpenAPI. No specific Java experience is needed. All you need is a passion for building clean, maintainable, and secure applications using an object-oriented language.

If you're working on the front-end, you'll be developing applications and reusable components using a combination of Ruby on Rails and React. You will also have the opportunity to build and develop our external and internal UIs, so this is an exciting opportunity to deliver far reaching, intuitive and accessible front-end systems.

As part of our ongoing mission to support and develop all staff within the DVLA, you will be given a high spec Macbook and we will help you to achieve certification in areas such as AWS and Java, as well as giving you the freedom and support necessary to perform in your role and continuously develop your skill set.

DVLA have been using AI coding assistants for over two years and actively encourage and support the appropriate use of AI coding tools. We have an AI

coding group and are working together to understand how to use AI coding assistants responsibly to build better digital services.

Your responsibilities will include, but aren't limited to:

- Working within a technical framework of the project to meet customer requirements.

- Developing Software in an agile team environment.

- Application Support.

- Working closely with business analysts and agile delivery managers to prepare and review user stories and tasks.

- Some testing responsibilities.

- Mentoring junior developers within the team.

Great line management is important to us as an organisation, and we will equip and support line managers to develop the skills they need. We aim to empower line managers to create teams where people can flourish and deliver excellent outcomes for the public.

For further information on the role, please read the attached role profile. Please note that the role profile is for information purposes only - whilst all elements are relevant to the role, they may not all be assessed during the recruitment process. This job advert will detail exactly what will be assessed during the recruitment process.

## **Person specification**

Required experience:

To be successful in this role you will need to have the following experience:

- Working as a software engineer across multiple teams and projects, developing software using a variety of modern technologies and tools.

- A passion for back-end, front-end development, security or serverless technology.

- You will need to be comfortable in using modern CI/CD tooling with an understanding of languages such as Java, Ruby, C#, HTML, Python or similar. As we develop, we are committed to the development of our

employees, so we will help you achieve certification in these areas as well as AWS and Azure.

You need to have a passion for modern software development technologies and standard methodologies.

You would need to have had to communicate with engineering peers and business partners.

### **Additional Information**

The role is part of the Government Digital and Data profession and utilises an enhanced Capability Based Pay Framework which provides access to a Digital and Data allowance.

The base pay is £44,241. In addition to this the role includes a Digital and Data allowance of up to £14,756.

The value of allowance awarded will be based on an assessment of your skills and experience as demonstrated through the selection process. [Here are more details on the pay framework.](#)

### **Working for the DVLA Digital Team**

At DVLA, licensing is just the start. Every project you implement, touch and deliver has a ripple effect that washes across the nation. Here the work you're doing has the capacity to change the way 53 million people interact with our services. As we aim to keep our roads some of the safest in the world, our innovative, transformative digital-led services help optimise a nation of individuals and business every single day.

To see how our people are transforming our digital services, head over to our [DVLA Digital Services Blog](#) and, to understand more about the great opportunities and benefits of working at DVLA read our [Inside DVLA blog](#).

### **Working hours, office attendance and travel requirements**

Full time roles consist of 37 hours per week. Whilst we welcome applications from those looking to work with us on a part-time basis, there is a business requirement for the successful candidate to be able to work at least **35** hours per week.

This role is suitable for hybrid working, which is a non-contractual arrangement where a combination of workplace and home-based working can be accommodated subject to business requirements.

The expectation at present is a minimum of 60% of your working time a month will be spent at either your designated workplace (the location cited in the advert) or, when required for business reasons, in another office/work location. There may be occasions where you are required to attend above the minimum expectation.

If you have a question about hybrid or flexible working or require a reasonable adjustment, please contact the Vacancy Holder during the recruitment process to avoid possible disappointment later in the process should your working arrangements not be compatible with the requirements of the role. To contact the vacancy holder, please use the job contact details listed under Contact point for applicants .

### **Security Check**

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is [security check](#). To allow for meaningful checks to be carried out, candidates will be required to have at least 5 years continuous residency in the UK. All applicants for this role must ensure that they meet this minimum residency requirement - if you do not, your application will be withdrawn.

### **Visa Sponsorship**

Please note that we do not hold a UK Visa & Immigration (UKVI) Skilled Worker Licence sponsor and are unable to sponsor any individuals for Skilled Worker Sponsorship. Candidates must ensure they have the appropriate rights to work in the UK before application.

### **Behaviours**

We'll assess you against these behaviours during the selection process:

Delivering at Pace

## Technical skills

We'll assess you against these technical skills during the selection process:

Modern Development Standards (Skill level: Practitioner)

Systems Design (Skill level: Practitioner)

Systems Integration (Skill level: Practitioner)

Programming and Build (Software Engineering) (Skill level: Practitioner)

## Benefits

Alongside your salary of £44,241, Driver and Vehicle Licensing Agency contributes £12,816 towards you being a member of the Civil Service Defined Benefit Pension scheme. [Find out what benefits a Civil Service Pension provides \(opens in a new window\).](#)

Passionate, reliable and always willing to push yourself and those around you, you'll continue to seek improvement in your own role and challenge us too. Because we pride ourselves on how we approach your development. From training courses to specialist skills workshops and opportunities to grow your expertise, we thrive when you thrive. You can find out more about all of the above [here](#) alongside a full list of our benefits:

Best in class learning and development tailored to your role

An environment with flexible working options where we encourage a great work-life balance

A culture encouraging inclusion and diversity with a range of staff communities to support all our colleagues

Generous employer contribution of 28.9%, depending on chosen [pension scheme](#)

Flexible working options where we encourage a great work-life balance.

Digital communities with clear career frameworks

On-site gym plus personal training available (membership applies)

On-site nursery, restaurants and coffee bar

25 days holiday (plus bank holidays), increasing by 1 each year (up to 30) & 8 Bank Holidays plus an additional Privilege Day to mark the King's birthday.

24-hour Employee Assistance Programme providing free confidential help and advice for staff.

Free parking

Find out more about [the benefits of working at DfT and its agencies](#) (opens in a new window).

## Things you need to know

### **Artificial intelligence**

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our [candidate guidance](#) (opens in a new window) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

### **Selection process details**

This vacancy is using [Success Profiles](#) (opens in a new window), and will assess your Behaviours, Experience and Technical skills.

Our selection process ensures a comprehensive assessment of each applicant's qualifications, skills, and potential fit within our organisation.

The selection process for this role will be:

Stage 1: Sift of CV & Personal statement

Stage 2: Interview

You must be successful at each stage to progress to the next stage.

## **Stage 1: Sift of CV & Personal Statement**

At sift, you will be assessed against the following Success Profile elements:

Experience you will be asked to provide a CV (unlimited wordcount) & Personal Statement (500 words). Please provide evidence of your Experience of the following essential criteria:

Working on one or more complex large-scale software delivery projects.

Experience in one or more technical specialisms such as Java, C#, front-end development or serverless technology.

This sift will take place week commencing 12th October 2026.

## **Stage 2: Interview**

At interview stage, you will be assessed against the following Success Profile elements:

- Behaviours: Delivering at Pace

- Technical:

[Senior Developer: Modern Development Standards \(Skill level: Practitioner\)](#)

[Senior Developer: Systems Design \(Skill level: Practitioner\)](#)

[Senior Developer: Systems Integration \(Skill level: Practitioner\)](#)

[Senior Developer: Programming and Build \(Software Engineering\) \(Skill level: Practitioner\)](#)

The interview will also include a White Board Exercise and a Coding Assessment.

The interviews will take place from 22nd October 2026.

This interview will be conducted online via Microsoft Teams. Further details will be provided to you should you be selected for interview.

You can find out more about [our hiring process, how to apply, and application and interview guidance on our careers site](#) (opens in a new window).

Please note that we will try to meet the dates set out in the advert. There may be occasions when these dates will change.

### **Further information on the selection process**

We will also hold a 12-month reserve list for this role, which may lead to potential opportunities beyond the role you applied for.

### **Reasonable Adjustments**

As a Disability Confident Leader employer, we are committed to ensuring that the recruitment process is fair, accessible and allows all candidates to perform at their best. If a person with a visible or non-visible disability is substantially disadvantaged, we have a duty to make reasonable changes to our processes.

Complete the Assistance required section in the Additional requirements page of your application form to tell us what changes or help you might need during the recruitment process. For instance, you may need wheelchair access at an interview, or if you're deaf, a Language Service Professional.

If you need a reasonable adjustment so that you can complete your application, you should contact Government Recruitment Service via [dftrecruitment.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk](mailto:dftrecruitment.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk) as soon as possible before the closing date to discuss your needs.

### **Document Accessibility**

This job advert contains links to the [DfT Careers website](#). Our website provides useful guidance and information that can support you during the application process. If you are experiencing accessibility problems with any attachments on this advert or the information on our website, please contact the email address in the 'Contact point for applicants' section.

### **Further Information**

For more information about how we hire, and for useful tips on submitting your application for this role, visit the [How We Hire](#) page of our DfT Careers website. You can find detailed information about the recruitment process and what to expect when applying for a role.

For further information on National Security Vetting please [visit the Demystifying Vetting website](#).

If your application is successful but you have been dismissed from the Civil Service, your application could be removed at the pre-employment checking stage depending on the nature of the dismissal.

Applicants who are successful at interview will be, as part of pre-employment screening, subject to a check on the Internal Fraud Database (IFD). This check will provide information about employees who have been dismissed for fraud or dishonesty offences. This check also applies to employees who resign or otherwise leave before being dismissed for fraud or dishonesty had their employment continued. Any applicant's details held on the IFD will be refused employment. A candidate is not eligible to apply for a role within the Civil Service if the application is made within a 5-year period following a dismissal for carrying out internal fraud against government.

All external applicants and current employees of accredited non-departmental public bodies (NDPBs) will be required to undergo a Social Media Check. A Social Media Check is a review of your publicly available online activity, typically across platforms like LinkedIn, Facebook, X (formerly Twitter), Instagram, and others. The purpose is to identify any public posts or content that could raise concerns for employers, such as:

- Hate speech or discriminatory behaviour

- Threats or acts of violence

- Illegal activity or substance misuse

- Sexually explicit material

- Extremist views or affiliations

Importantly, this check does not involve hacking into your accounts or accessing private messages. It only considers content you have chosen to make public. Employers use this kind of screening to help ensure their workplace remains safe, inclusive, and aligned with company values. It's not

about judging your personality or lifestyle - it's about checking for potential red flags that might affect the role or company culture. If you have questions or concerns about the social media check, we would be happy to explain in more detail what's being looked at and how your data is handled securely and fairly.

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

## **Security**

Successful candidates must undergo a basic (or equivalent) criminal record check.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is [security check \(opens in a new window\)](#).

[See our vetting charter \(opens in a new window\)](#).

People working with government assets must complete [baseline personnel security standard \(opens in new window\)](#) checks.

## **Nationality requirements**

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

- UK nationals

- nationals of the Republic of Ireland

- nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK

- nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status under the [European Union Settlement Scheme \(EUSS\) \(opens in a new window\)](#)

- nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)

individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020

Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

[Further information on nationality requirements \(opens in a new window\)](#)

## **Working for the Civil Service**

The [Civil Service Code \(opens in a new window\)](#) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's [recruitment principles \(opens in a new window\)](#).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

## **Diversity and Inclusion**

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan \(opens in a new window\)](#) and the [Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy \(opens in a new window\)](#).

## **Apply and further information**

This vacancy is part of the [Great Place to Work for Veterans \(opens in a new window\)](#) initiative.

The Civil Service welcomes applications from people who have recently left prison or have an unspent conviction. [Read more about prison leaver recruitment \(opens in new window\)](#).

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

## Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name : ITS Recruitment

Email : [itsrecruitment@dvla.gov.uk](mailto:itsrecruitment@dvla.gov.uk)

Recruitment team

Email : [dftrecruitment.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk](mailto:dftrecruitment.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk)

## Further information

If you feel your application has not been treated in accordance with the Recruitment Principles and you wish to make a complaint, in the first instance, you should contact Government Recruitment Services via email: [dftrecruitment.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk](mailto:dftrecruitment.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk)

If you are not satisfied with the response you receive from the Department, you can contact the Civil Service Commission: Visit the Civil Service Commission website [Here](#)

